

Fig 10.16: Rich sources of omega-3 fatty acids

the methyl end. Omega-6 fats, also known as linoleic acid, are available only in food. The human body cannot make them, so they are considered as essential fats. They support brain function, bone health, reproductive health, hair growth and regulation of metabolism. Good sources of linoleic acid include vegetable oils.

10.10.3 On the basis of requirement

Fatty acids are of 2 types:

1) Essential Fatty Acids

Fatty acids which are essential to be taken in our diet because they cannot be synthesized in our body are known as Essential Fatty Acids. (eg.) Linoleic, linolenic and arachidonic acids.

2) Non-Essential Fatty Acids

Non-Essential Fatty Acids are those which can be synthesized by the body and which need not be supplied through the diet. Palmitic acid, oleic acid and butyric acid are examples of non– essential fatty acids.

10.10.4 On the basis of sources

Fats are divided into 2 types based on their source, namely visible and invisible fats. Some fats and oils added to food or used for



Fig 10.17: Rich sources of omega-6 fatty acids

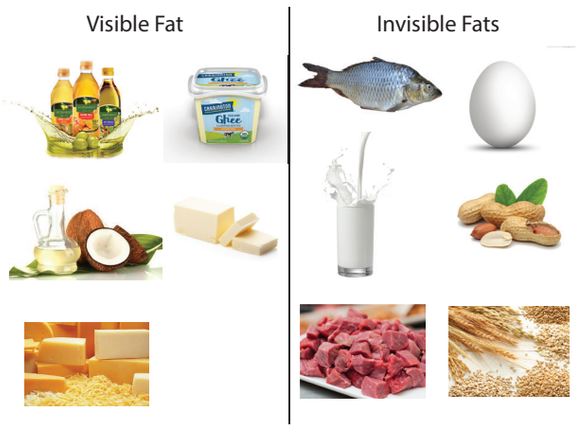


Fig 10.18: Sources of visible and invisible fats

ACTIVITY - 4

Match the right answer

1) Fish oil	-	MUFA
2) Olive oil	-	Saturated fat
3) Corn oil	-	Omega 3 fatty acid
4) Cholesterol	-	Pulses
5) Red meat	-	Omega 6 fatty acid
6) Invisible fat	-	Organ meats

frying are visible fats. These are also known as pure fats. Many foods like milk, cream, egg yolk, meat, fish and even cereals and legumes contribute substantial amount of invisible fats (not visible in the food) to the diet.

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